Abdullah Al Zahid

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October 26, 2026

Lina Truong
Human Resources
Toronto Water, City of Toronto

Re: Engineer, Water Infrastructure Management, Policy Development (Job ID 67403)

Dear Lina Truong,

I would like to apply for the Engineer position with the Policy Development team in Toronto Water's Water Infrastructure Management section. I should say at the outset that I come to it from transportation planning rather than stormwater, and I have tried to be clear below about both what I would bring and where I fall short.

Much of the posting is policy work: developing strategies, policies and guidelines, accounting for legislation and initiatives by other orders of government, and writing reports to Committees and Council. That is the part of my current job I would bring. In Transportation Planning I advise applicants and staff on transportation planning, by-laws and related regulations, monitor the effect of zoning regulations, and with policy staff recommend and report to Council on new transportation regulations and guidelines. I review development applications against City standards and Official Plan policy, and I write the briefing notes and presentations that carry findings to senior staff.

I also run assigned studies from scoping through to recommendations, coordinate with divisions, consultants and outside agencies, and built the Transportation Data Dashboard, which brought several years of survey data into one validated source the division reports from. At Metrolinx I set up a command line workflow that pre-simulated slow orders in batches, cutting turnaround on scenario requests from days to hours, and built the Crew Variance Tool, a Python application that read large JSON operations files and summarised speed profiles and run-time variance across subdivisions.

The gaps are substantial. The posting's first qualification is registration as a P.Eng. with PEO, and I am not registered. I do not have the three years of experience in the planning, design or construction of storm drainage and stormwater management infrastructure that the posting asks for, and I have not worked under the Ontario Water Resources Act or the Environmental Protection Act, or prepared business cases and bid documents. I am applying because the policy and reporting side of the role is familiar, and because the Qualified List covers permanent and temporary positions.

Thank you for considering my application.

Sincerely,

Abdullah Al Zahid

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